

Executive Memo

MEMORANDUM

TO: Regional Sales Director, Midwest Liquor Distribution

FROM: Alexandros Miteloudis, Data Analyst

DATE: July 13, 2026

SUBJECT: 10-Year Transaction Analysis: Regional Market Share & SKU Performance

1. Executive Summary

An analysis of our 10-year sampled transaction data (2012–2022) reveals a highly concentrated market driven heavily by the Des Moines metropolitan area and a few dominant product SKUs. While top-performing cities consistently purchase our top 11 statewide items, smaller cities exhibit distinct purchasing behaviors. Furthermore, after a historic sales peak in 2016, recent data shows a concerning revenue decline from 2021 to 2022 that requires immediate strategic review.

2. The Business Objective

The goal of this analysis was to evaluate decade-long sales performance across Iowa, identify our most profitable geographic markets, pinpoint top-performing products, and uncover macroeconomic trends affecting our revenue.

3. Key Findings

- **Des Moines Dominates Regional Sales:** When standardizing regional data, Des Moines outpaces all other cities by a significant margin in total dollar sales. The top 4 metropolitan areas are heavily reliant on our top 11 statewide best-sellers.
- **SKU Concentration & "Niche" City Power:** The item *Juarez Gold DSS* is the undisputed top seller by a wide margin. Interestingly, while major cities stick to the statewide top 11 items, some of our overall top-selling items (like *Jack Daniels Single Barrel*) do not appear in the top cities' specific breakdowns. This indicates that smaller cities possess strong, concentrated buying power for specific niche products.
- **The 2016 Peak and Recent Decline:** Sales experienced a massive spike in 2016, followed by a normalization period. However, the most critical finding is a distinct negative trend and revenue drop from 2021 to 2022, hitting a recent low.

4. Actionable Recommendations

Based on these insights, I recommend the following immediate actions:

1. Optimize Metro vs. Rural Inventory: Ensure our top 11 statewide SKUs (especially *Juarez Gold DSS*) are heavily stocked in Des Moines and the top 4 metros. Conversely, do not cut inventory of "niche" top-sellers in smaller cities, as they drive localized revenue.
2. Investigate the 2021–2022 Revenue Drop: Launch a cross-functional review with the supply chain and pricing teams to determine if the recent decline was caused by post-pandemic supply issues, increased competitor pricing, or shifting consumer preferences.
3. Cross-Sell in Underperforming Regions: Identify smaller cities that are under-purchasing our #1 SKU (*Juarez Gold DSS*) and run targeted B2B promotions with those specific store owners to boost volume.

5. Next Steps & Resources

The full interactive dashboard has been built to allow the sales team to drill down into these metrics by date, city, and specific item.

- View Interactive Dashboard:
<https://app.powerbi.com/groups/me/reports/4bf14fc4-062d-4d57-8ac3-ee2133e2160d/8ee0bd2f583bb2f258c9?experience=power-bi>
- View Data & Methodology:
https://github.com/AlexandrosMiteloudis/Iowa_Liquor_Sales_Data_Analysis

